

Items, Technology, and Logistics

In the modern world, information is a weapon, and your smartphone is a tracking device. Equipment in *Zero Sum* is about survival, staying off the grid, and gathering intelligence.

Everyday Paranoia Gear

- **Burner Phones (Pre-paid):** Essential for communication. Must be discarded after a few uses or a specific operation. (Cost: Low. Availability: High).
- **Faraday Bags:** Pouches lined with metallic mesh that block all electromagnetic signals. Used to transport phones or laptops without being tracked via GPS, Wi-Fi, or cell towers.
- **Directional Microphones & Laser Mics:** Used for surveillance from a distance. Laser mics can read vibrations off glass windows to listen to conversations inside a room.
- **YubiKeys / Hardware Tokens:** Physical security keys required for accessing encrypted drives. If the players lose it, the data is gone forever.

Cyber Warfare Tools

- **Stingray (IMSI Catcher):** A device the size of a suitcase that mimics a cell phone tower, forcing all nearby phones to connect to it. Used to intercept calls, texts, and track locations. Highly illegal, heavily used by law enforcement and private intelligence.
- **Zero-Click Exploits:** Software that can compromise a target's phone just by sending them a message (they don't even have to click a link). Grants full access to camera, microphone, and encrypted apps. Extremely rare and expensive.
- **Tails OS USB Drives:** An amnesic incognito operating system that boots from a USB stick and routes all traffic through the Tor network, leaving no trace on the host computer.

Firearms and Violence

Guns are loud, leave forensic evidence, and escalate the Heat Level immediately. * **Concealed Handguns (e.g., Glock 19, Sig P365):** The most common weapons. Easy to hide, but firing one without a suppressor guarantees a police response within minutes in an urban area. * **Untraceable “Ghost Guns”:** 3D-printed receivers combined with standard parts. No serial numbers. Expensive to acquire on the black market, but vital for deniable operations. * **Trauma Kits:** Since hospitals are required to report gunshot wounds, players must rely on military-grade trauma kits (tourniquets, QuikClot, chest seals) and underground doctors to survive.

Financial Tools

- **Monero / Privacy Coins:** The only way to move money anonymously. Bitcoin is entirely traceable by forensic accountants.
- **Pre-paid Debit Cards (Straw Purchases):** Bought with cash by a third party (a “straw buyer”) to pay for hotels, servers, or travel without linking to the player’s identity.